



DIVERSIFYING CRUDE BASKET

Under G. Krishnakumar, who was the CMD between 2022-25, Bharat Petroleum Corporation increased exposure to the spot oil market and diversified its crude basket to mitigate geopolitical risks

BY **RICHA SHARMA**

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THE ESCALATION OF the conflict in West Asia, which is impacting oil and gas supply across the world, underscores the importance of diversified sourcing, flexible procurement strategies, adequate inventory buffers, and active risk management frameworks.

This is exactly what Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL), a public-sector oil and gas company, is doing. In view of these initiatives, ex-BPCL CMD G. Krishnakumar has been recognised as the Urban Visionary in the BT-PWC India's Best CEOs this year. He retired in April 2025.

"During 2022 to 2025, we navigated a global landscape where 'weaponisation' of energy and geopolitical

disruptions, such as the Russia-Ukraine war and Red Sea supply chain realignments, fundamentally redefined crude sourcing," says Krishnakumar.

On realising the impact of geopolitical risks on energy security of the country, BPCL undertook struc-

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Urban Visionary—Oil & Gas

G. KRISHNAKUMAR

EX-CMD, BPCL

Gross Sales	FY25	5,00,517
	9MFY26	3,87,873
Operating Profit	FY25	28,086
	9MFY26	33,474
Profit After Tax	FY25	13,337
	9MFY26	18,285
	FY25 RoE (%)	16.99
	Market Cap	1,22,454

● Figures in ₹ crore; financials are on consolidated basis; 9MFY26: April-December 2025

● M cap as on March 24, 2026

● Source: ACE Equity